13. Oliver (1971): 101.

14. Ibid.: 89.

15. Ibid.: 132.

16. Orality and memorization continue to be part of priestly culture in contemporary India. See Fuller (2001).

17. Lopez (1995): 38.

18. While there is a debate on the date of the Buddha's death—or his 'Parinibbana' as it is called in Buddhist tradition—with the dates ranging from the fifth to the fourth centuries BCE, it is *c*. 480 BCE that I accept here as the date of his death. Since he is said to have lived for about eighty years, his birth would have been around 540 BCE. For a summary of the various dates, Singh (2009): 257.

19. 'Thus have I heard' is how the *Maha-Parinibbana-Sutta* (The Book of the Great Decease), I. 1, begins. See Rhys Davids (1881): 1. In the same chapter, while recounting the Buddha's interaction with bhikkhus (Buddhist monks), the Buddha is on more than one occasion shown as addressing the monks thus: 'Listen well, and attend, and I will speak.' *Maha-Parinibbana-Sutta* 1.6 and 1.7. See Rhys Davids (1881): 6–7.

20. *Arthashastra* (*AS* hereafter) 1.5.14. Kane (1972): 11. 'Itihasa', in the opinion of the text, was made up of the *Puranas*, *Itivrtta*, *Akhyayika*, *Udaharana*, *Dharmashastra*, and *Arthashastra*.

21. Fittingly, the title of Chakrabarti's (2011) book on Ashoka is *Royal Messages by the Wayside*.

22. The silver tetradrachm of Ptolemy I of Egypt, for instance, showed Alexander with an elephant headdress and the horns of the Egyptian god Ammon. For a description and photograph, Cherry (2007): 259. Allen's book contains an illustration of a silver coin issued by Alexander which bears an image of the conqueror himself, which Allen says is 'the only known image of Alexander to survive from his lifetime.' No specific details are provided: see Allen (2012): 47. Apparently, this medallion was issued in very small numbers after the battle of the Hydaspes (the name of the Jhelum river in classical sources). Romm (2012): 216.

23. Cherry (2007): 295.

24. Historians of the ancient world, such as Plutarch and Cassius Dio Cocceianus, wrote about Cleopatra. While Plutarch saw her as manipulative, Dio's Cleopatra had insatiable passion and avarice. In the medieval world, the traveller and historian Al-Masudi introduced another version of the queen—as a philosopher and author. Among the most popular depictions has been Shakespeare's,